Math report card comments by grade

Find the student's grade band and pick two or three skills. For each, use a **strength** or **on track** line, then at most one **next step** and one thing to try **at home**. Swap [Name] and "their" for the student's name and pronoun, and check each line against your own grade-level standards.

Grades K–2

Addition and subtraction facts

- **STRENGTH** [Name] knows their addition and subtraction facts to 10 by heart and uses them to solve bigger problems.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] recalls facts to 20 quickly and explains strategies such as making ten.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] knows many addition facts to 10 and counts on for the rest.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is building quick recall of their facts to 10 and is getting faster each week.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is learning their addition and subtraction facts to 10 by heart, which we're practicing with short daily fact games.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could play quick-fire fact games in the car or while cooking ("what's 4 and 6?").

Place value and number sense

- **STRENGTH** [Name] understands tens and ones and explains what each digit in a number is worth.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] compares and orders numbers to 100 confidently.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is beginning to understand tens and ones using blocks and number lines.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] reads and writes numbers to 100 and is learning what each digit means.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is understanding tens and ones (that 34 is 3 tens and 4 ones), which we're practicing with blocks and number lines.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could count coins or group small objects into tens together.

Adding and subtracting

- **STRENGTH** [Name] adds and subtracts two-digit numbers accurately and explains how.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] chooses smart strategies for adding and subtracting, such as counting on from the bigger number.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] adds and subtracts within 20 and is beginning to work with bigger numbers.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] solves adding problems confidently and is getting more secure with subtracting.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is subtracting with two-digit numbers, which we're practicing using number lines and blocks.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could make up quick shopping problems together, adding two prices or working out change.

Measurement, time and money

- **STRENGTH** [Name] tells the time to the half hour and knows the value of each coin.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] measures length accurately with a ruler and compares measurements.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is learning to tell the time to the hour and half hour.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] measures objects and is learning to use a ruler correctly.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is telling the time on a clock with hands, which we're practicing with toy clocks and our daily routines.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could ask [Name] to read the time on a clock with hands at a few points in the day.

Shapes and geometry

- **STRENGTH** [Name] names and describes 2D and 3D shapes by their sides, corners and faces.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] spots shapes everywhere and sorts them by their properties.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] names common shapes and is learning to describe their sides and corners.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is beginning to name 3D shapes such as cubes and cylinders.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is describing shapes by their sides and corners, which we're practicing with building and sorting activities.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could go on a shape hunt around the house or at the park.

Graphs and data

- **STRENGTH** [Name] makes and reads tally charts and bar graphs and answers questions about them.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] collects information in a class survey and shows it clearly in a chart.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] reads simple bar graphs and is learning to make their own.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is learning to collect information with tally marks.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is reading information from tally charts and simple graphs, which we're practicing with class surveys.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could make a tally chart together, such as the colors of cars that go past.

Word problems

- **STRENGTH** [Name] reads word problems carefully, picks the right operation and explains the answer.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] solves problems with more than one step by breaking them into smaller parts.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] solves one-step word problems and is learning to tackle problems with more than one step.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is getting better at working out which operation a problem needs.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is reading a problem carefully and drawing a picture before solving it, which we're practicing with a step-by-step routine we use for every problem.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could talk through everyday problems together, such as how many packs to buy for a party.

Explaining thinking

- **STRENGTH** [Name] explains their thinking clearly, out loud and in writing.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] shows each step clearly so that others can follow the method.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is starting to explain their methods out loud and is learning to write them down.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] shows some steps in their work and is learning to include each one.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is explaining their thinking in words, pictures or numbers, not just the answer, which we're practicing with sentence starters and talk partners.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could ask "how did you work that out?" when [Name] does homework.

Checking work

- **STRENGTH** [Name] checks answers carefully and catches their own mistakes.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] works accurately and estimates first to check that answers make sense.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is becoming more careful and is starting to check answers before handing work in.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] catches some of their own mistakes and is building a habit of checking.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is slowing down and checking each answer before handing work in, which we're practicing with a short checklist at the end of each task.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could ask [Name] to check one answer in each homework task by estimating.

Confidence and persistence

- **STRENGTH** [Name] tackles challenging problems with confidence and keeps going when a problem is tricky.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] enjoys a challenge and is willing to try different strategies.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is growing in confidence and is more willing to try harder problems.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is learning to keep going when a problem is tricky and asks for help when needed.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is having a go at challenging problems and trying a second strategy before asking for help, which we're practicing with problems that build up in small steps and praise for good strategies.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could praise effort and strategies ("you tried two ways") as well as right answers.

Grades 3–5

Times tables

- **STRENGTH** [Name] knows their times tables by heart and uses them confidently in division.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] recalls multiplication facts quickly, which frees them up for harder problems.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] knows the 2, 5 and 10 times tables and is learning the 3s and 4s.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is building quick recall of their times tables and uses known facts to work out new ones.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is learning their times tables by heart, starting with the 3s, 4s and 8s, which we're practicing with short daily practice and games.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could practice one times table for five minutes, out loud or with a game.

Place value and number sense

- **STRENGTH** [Name] understands place value to a million and rounds numbers accurately.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] reads, compares and rounds large numbers with confidence.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] reads and writes large numbers and is getting more confident with rounding.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] understands place value to thousands and is working with larger numbers.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is rounding numbers and knowing what each digit is worth in larger numbers, which we're practicing with place value charts and number lines.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could look at prices or distances together and round them to the nearest ten or hundred.

Adding and subtracting

- **STRENGTH** [Name] adds and subtracts large numbers accurately using written methods.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] checks their adding and subtracting by estimating first.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] adds and subtracts larger numbers and is becoming more accurate with written methods.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] uses written methods for adding and is getting more secure with subtracting.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is subtracting larger numbers accurately, especially across zeros, which we're practicing with worked examples and estimating first.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could make up quick shopping problems together, adding two prices or working out change.

Multiplying and dividing

- **STRENGTH** [Name] multiplies and divides larger numbers accurately and explains each step.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] uses multiplication and division confidently to solve problems.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] multiplies two-digit numbers and is starting to divide with remainders.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] understands what multiplication and division mean and is getting quicker with written methods.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is dividing larger numbers and deciding what to do with a remainder, which we're practicing with arrays, drawings and step-by-step examples.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could share out snacks or coins evenly and talk about what's left over.

Fractions

- **STRENGTH** [Name] compares, adds and subtracts fractions confidently and explains their reasoning with drawings.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] understands equivalent fractions and places fractions on a number line.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] understands what a fraction means and is learning to compare fractions.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] finds equivalent fractions with pictures and is moving on to adding fractions.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is comparing fractions and finding equivalent fractions, which we're practicing with fraction strips, drawings and number lines.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could use fractions when cooking or sharing food ("is a third bigger or smaller than a quarter?").

Measurement, time and money

- **STRENGTH** [Name] converts between units and solves time and money problems accurately.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] reads scales carefully and works out the area and perimeter of shapes.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] measures accurately and is learning to convert between units.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] finds the perimeter of shapes and is moving on to area.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is converting between units and working out how much time has passed, which we're practicing with real measuring tasks and timelines.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could involve [Name] in measuring for cooking or working out how long a journey will take.

Shapes and geometry

- **STRENGTH** [Name] sorts shapes by their angles and sides and measures angles accurately.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] uses a protractor accurately and understands angle facts.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] names and sorts shapes and is learning to measure angles.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] recognizes lines of symmetry and is moving on to angles.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is measuring and drawing angles accurately, which we're practicing with protractors and hands-on activities.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could look for right angles and smaller or bigger angles around the house.

Graphs and data

- **STRENGTH** [Name] draws accurate graphs and explains what the data shows.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] reads line graphs and tables accurately and explains what they show.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] reads bar graphs and tables and is learning to draw their own with a sensible scale.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is getting more confident reading information from tables and charts.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is drawing graphs with a sensible scale and reading values accurately, which we're practicing with class data projects.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could look at a chart in the news or a weather app and talk about what it shows.

Word problems

- **STRENGTH** [Name] reads word problems carefully, picks the right operation and explains the answer.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] solves problems with more than one step by breaking them into smaller parts.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] solves one-step word problems and is learning to tackle problems with more than one step.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is getting better at working out which operation a problem needs.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is reading a problem carefully and drawing a picture or model before solving it, which we're practicing with a step-by-step routine we use for every problem.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could talk through everyday problems together, such as how many packs to buy for a party.

Explaining thinking

- **STRENGTH** [Name] explains their thinking clearly, out loud and in writing.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] shows each step clearly so that others can follow the method.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is starting to explain their methods out loud and is learning to write them down.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] shows some steps in their work and is learning to include each one.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is explaining their thinking in words, pictures or numbers, not just the answer, which we're practicing with sentence starters and talk partners.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could ask "how did you work that out?" when [Name] does homework.

Checking work

- **STRENGTH** [Name] checks answers carefully and catches their own mistakes.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] works accurately and estimates first to check that answers make sense.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is becoming more careful and is starting to check answers before handing work in.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] catches some of their own mistakes and is building a habit of checking.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is slowing down and checking each answer before handing work in, which we're practicing with a short checklist at the end of each task.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could ask [Name] to check one answer in each homework task by estimating.

Confidence and persistence

- **STRENGTH** [Name] tackles challenging problems with confidence and keeps going when a problem is tricky.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] enjoys a challenge and is willing to try different strategies.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is growing in confidence and is more willing to try harder problems.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is learning to keep going when a problem is tricky and asks for help when needed.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is having a go at challenging problems and trying a second strategy before asking for help, which we're practicing with problems that build up in small steps and praise for good strategies.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could praise effort and strategies ("you tried two ways") as well as right answers.

Homework and practice

- **STRENGTH** [Name] completes their homework carefully and on time.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] hands in careful, thorough homework and uses it to practice new skills.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] hands in most homework on time and is building a regular routine.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] completes homework and is learning to ask for help when a task is unclear.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is handing in homework on time each week, which we're practicing with a weekly checklist and reminders on the class page.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could agree a regular time and place for homework and check the planner together.

Grades 6–8

Mental math and fluency

- **STRENGTH** [Name] works fluently with all four operations, including mental calculations.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] recalls facts quickly and estimates answers before calculating.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is accurate with written methods and is getting quicker with mental calculations.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] uses known facts well and is building speed with mental calculation.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is quick, accurate mental calculation, so harder problems don't get stuck on the arithmetic, which we're practicing with short starter activities at the beginning of lessons.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could ask [Name] to estimate totals when shopping or splitting a bill.

Fractions, decimals and percentages

- **STRENGTH** [Name] moves easily between fractions, decimals and percentages and uses them to solve problems.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] calculates percentages accurately, including discounts and increases.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] converts between fractions, decimals and percentages and is getting more confident using them in problems.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] calculates simple percentages and is moving on to percentage increase and decrease.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is working out percentages of amounts and percentage change, which we're practicing with real-life problems such as discounts and tips.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could work out sale discounts together when shopping ("what's 20% off?").

Ratio and proportion

- **STRENGTH** [Name] solves ratio and rate problems confidently using tables and diagrams.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] spots proportional relationships quickly and explains them clearly.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] understands what a ratio means and is getting more confident scaling recipes and rates.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] solves simple ratio problems and is starting on unit rates.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is solving ratio and rate problems, such as best-buy comparisons, which we're practicing with tables and bar diagrams.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could compare prices per item when shopping together and decide which pack is the better buy.

Negative numbers

- **STRENGTH** [Name] works confidently with negative numbers in all four operations.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] uses negative numbers accurately in real contexts such as temperature and money.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] orders and adds negative numbers and is learning to subtract and multiply them.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] understands negative numbers on a number line and is building confidence with the rules.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is calculating with negative numbers, which we're practicing using number lines and real examples such as temperature.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could look at weather forecasts together and work out how much the temperature changes.

Expressions and equations

- **STRENGTH** [Name] solves equations confidently and explains each step.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] writes and simplifies expressions accurately and uses algebra to solve problems.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] solves one-step equations and is moving on to two-step equations.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] understands that a letter can stand for a number and is learning to simplify expressions.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is solving two-step equations and checking the answer, which we're practicing with worked examples and balance diagrams.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could try "think of a number" puzzles together and work backwards to find the start.

Shapes and geometry

- **STRENGTH** [Name] calculates area, volume and angles accurately and explains which formula to use.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] solves geometry problems confidently, including angles in triangles and on parallel lines.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] finds the area of triangles and rectangles and is moving on to more complex shapes.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] uses angle facts and is building confidence with longer geometry problems.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is choosing the right formula for area and volume and showing each step, which we're practicing with worked examples and practical measuring.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could estimate and then measure the area of a room together.

Graphs and data

- **STRENGTH** [Name] calculates the mean, median and range accurately and explains what they show about the data.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] draws and interprets graphs carefully, including spotting misleading ones.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] finds the mean, median and range and is learning when to use each.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] reads charts accurately and is building confidence explaining what data shows.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is choosing the right average and explaining what a graph shows, which we're practicing with real data sets.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could look at sports statistics or a chart in the news and talk about what it shows.

Word problems

- **STRENGTH** [Name] reads word problems carefully, picks the right operation and explains the answer.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] solves problems with more than one step by breaking them into smaller parts.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] solves one-step word problems and is learning to tackle problems with more than one step.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is getting better at working out which operation a problem needs.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is breaking longer problems into smaller steps and showing each one, which we're practicing with a step-by-step routine we use for every problem.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could talk through everyday problems together, such as how many packs to buy for a party.

Explaining thinking

- **STRENGTH** [Name] explains their thinking clearly, out loud and in writing.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] shows each step clearly so that others can follow the method.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is starting to explain their methods out loud and is learning to write them down.
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- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is explaining their thinking in words, pictures or numbers, not just the answer, which we're practicing with sentence starters and talk partners.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could ask "how did you work that out?" when [Name] does homework.

Checking work

- **STRENGTH** [Name] checks answers carefully and catches their own mistakes.
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- **ON TRACK** [Name] catches some of their own mistakes and is building a habit of checking.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is slowing down and checking each answer before handing work in, which we're practicing with a short checklist at the end of each task.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could ask [Name] to check one answer in each homework task by estimating.

Confidence and persistence

- **STRENGTH** [Name] tackles challenging problems with confidence and keeps going when a problem is tricky.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] enjoys a challenge and is willing to try different strategies.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is growing in confidence and is more willing to try harder problems.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] is learning to keep going when a problem is tricky and asks for help when needed.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is having a go at challenging problems and trying a second strategy before asking for help, which we're practicing with problems that build up in small steps and praise for good strategies.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could praise effort and strategies ("you tried two ways") as well as right answers.

Homework and practice

- **STRENGTH** [Name] completes their homework carefully and on time.
- **STRENGTH** [Name] hands in careful, thorough homework and uses it to practice new skills.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] hands in most homework on time and is building a regular routine.
- **ON TRACK** [Name] completes homework and is learning to ask for help when a task is unclear.
- **NEXT STEP** Our next step is handing in homework on time each week, which we're practicing with a weekly checklist and reminders on the class page.
- **AT HOME** At home, you could agree a regular time and place for homework and check the planner together.

Math phrases to avoid, rewritten

Instead of	Write
Leo makes careless mistakes.	Leo often rushes to finish, which leads to avoidable mistakes. Our next step is checking each answer before handing work in, using a three-point checklist.
Mia is bad at math.	Mia is still building confidence with number facts and finds word problems tricky. Short daily fact games and drawing each problem first are helping.
Sam doesn't know his times tables.	Sam knows his 2, 5 and 10 times tables and is learning the 3s and 4s. Five minutes of practice a few times a week at home would help them stick.
Ava still counts on her fingers.	Ava counts on accurately and is learning more addition facts by heart, so she needs to count less often.
Omar is not a math person.	Omar is at his best with hands-on problems. Our next step is writing down each step, so his method is as clear on paper as it is when he explains it.
Grace has math anxiety.	Grace sometimes hesitates to start a new problem. Starting with an example we do together, then trying one on her own, is building her confidence.
Kai never shows his work.	Kai often gets the right answer in his head. Our next step is writing down each step, so he can check his method and get credit for it.
Ethan is lazy about homework.	Ethan has handed in four of the last eight homework tasks. We go through a weekly checklist on Mondays, and a regular homework time at home would help.
Priya is in the bottom set for maths.	Priya is working on her number facts and on reading problems carefully, with extra practice in a small group. She now knows her 2, 5 and 10 times tables.
Noah is failing math.	Noah's math grade this quarter is a D, mainly because of the fractions unit. He has extra practice at lunch on Wednesdays, and the retake on 20 November will replace the unit test score.
Zoe gives up when it gets hard.	Zoe sometimes stops when a problem looks hard. We're practicing a 'try two ways first' strategy, and she is having a go more often.
Ben relies on a calculator.	Ben uses a calculator confidently. Our next step is mental calculation, so the calculator becomes a check rather than the first step.
Lily is weak at fractions.	Lily understands what a fraction means and is learning to compare fractions. Fraction strips and drawings are helping.
Jack is a math whiz.	Jack knows his facts by heart and spots patterns quickly. His next challenge is explaining why a method works, not just using it.
Isla finds math hard, just like her mum did.	Leave family comparisons out. "Isla is building confidence with times tables, and praising effort and strategies at home will help."
Ruby can decompose numbers and uses the standard algorithm.	Ruby can split numbers into tens and ones to add them in her head, and uses the column method accurately on paper.
Eli might have dyscalculia.	Don't write it. Talk to the family in person and follow your school's process. The report can describe what you see and what helps: "Eli is still learning number facts to 10, and daily games with objects are helping."
Maya should know her tables by now.	Maya is learning her 6, 7 and 8 times tables. Our next step is quick recall, with five minutes of practice a few times a week.
Finn needs to focus, needs to show his work and needs to check his answers.	Finn's next step is showing each step of his working, which will also help him spot his own mistakes.
Theo is a pleasure to have in math class.	Theo asks great questions in math and likes to know why a method works, not just how to use it.

230 lines. Free from polytheseus.com/teacher-skills/guides/report-card-comments-for-math, where a free builder puts them together and checks the wording. Drafted with AI help: read every line against what you know of the student and your school's report rules before you use it.